

20 AUG 02

I REITERATE - KEEP IT SIMPLE¹¹

WHEN I ASKED THAT TOP SGT WHO RAN THE NCO CLUB AT MACDILL ABOUT PERHAPS USING THOSE AIRCRAFT AS 'FILLER' FOR HIS MONTHLY CLUB CALENDAR MAGAZINE DUE TO HIM NOT HAVING ENOUGH, DUE TO THE SGT BEING ON FURLOUGH WHO USUALLY PROVIDED ANY NEEDED —

NCO CLUB MGR TOLD ME (HE HAD BEEN ON BASE FOR A LONG TIME) IN ANSWER TO MY QUESTION "UNLESS THEY ARE TOP SECRET OR SOMETHING?" "ABOUT USING AS FILLER" — THAT HE NOR ANYONE ELSE REALLY KNEW WHAT THEY WERE FOR OR THEIR USE. THEY WERE JUST PARKED THERE FOR YEARS. SO, HE WOULD TELEPHONE WHERE THEY KEPT, ON BASE, AND FIND OUT, SAID HE THOUGHT THEY MUST BE SOME KIND OF "TEST" AIRCRAFT, BUT NO ONE KNEW MUCH.

MIKE - ALL HAD "EXPERIMENTAL" ON THEM WHEN I SAW PARKED. AND ONLY 4 THERE - SO, OBVIOUSLY THEY WOULD SEEM TO BE ONLY THAT, AND SIMPLY NOT PAID TOO MUCH ATTENTION TO EXCEPT AS SOME SORT OF AIR FORCE EXPERIMENTAL / TEST AIRCRAFT BY ANY ON BASE FLYING PERSONNEL WHO SAW THEM. NOT VERY MANY PEOPLE KNEW ANYTHING ABOUT THEM. MANY USAF BASES HAD "TEST" AND "EXPERIMENTAL" PLANES FROM TIME TO TIME, SO, NO BIG DEAL. THOSE 4 AIRCRAFT TURNED OUT TO BE THE LAST 4 REMAINING OF THE UTTERMOST TOP-SECRET AIRCRAFT EVER BUILT!!!

(OVER)

MIKE- STILL KEEPING IT SIMPLE, OR TRYING TO -

HOW COULD ANY USAF PILOT, FLYING WHAT HE BELIEVED TO BE THE BEST JET FIGHTER IN THE WORLD, KNOW OR EVEN BELIEVE THAT THOSE DISC AIRCRAFT HE SAW EVERYTIME HE TOOK-OFF AND LANDED, PARKED OUT IN THE OPEN LIKE THEY WERE, NEAR THE RUNWAY HE WAS USING - ON MACDILL AFB - NEAR THE SCRAP PILE - HOW COULD HE KNOW OR BELIEVE THAT THOSE 4 AIRCRAFT - AND MANY MORE PREVIOUSLY JUST LIKE THEM, EACH COULD FLY RINGS AROUND AND LEAVE IN THE DUST THE MAGNIFICANT USAF JET FIGHTER HE WAS IN AND FLYING OVER THEM ????

MIKE, I AM SOMETIMES STILL TOTALLY ASTOUNDED THAT I TURNED OUT TO BE THE ONLY CIVILIAN WHO EVER SAW WHAT I WAS SHOWN, AND TOLD WHAT I WAS TOLD, CONCERNING THE ABSOLUTE MOST ULTRA TOP SECRET PROJECT SET FLYING WING DISC AIRCRAFT WHICH EVEN EXISTED. AND YES, I ALSO STILL REMEMBER VIVIDLY, WALKING UP TO, AND KICKING THE TIRES ON ONE OF OUR REAL FLYING SAUCERS! - WHILE AN AIR FORCE PHOTOGRAPHER TOOK A PICTURE OF ME DOING IT.

I PERSONALLY KNOW THAT WAS ALSO A SIMPLY UNIQUE ONE OF A KIND EXPERIENCE.